

FIELDCELL · CALCULATION

FieldCell sizing calculations

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

Document ID	FCL-CAL-001	Version	0.1
Status	Draft	Date	2026-09-25
Author	Amish Chadha	License	CERN-OHL-S-2.0
Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/fieldcell		
Source	docs/04-calcs/01-sizing.md @ uncommitted		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	First issue for TRL 3 (energy, PV yield, load, electrical, mass and stability, thermal, wind, deploy, noise, cost)

FieldCell sizing calculations

On paper, FieldCell meets six of its twelve requirements, misses two and has two at risk; two more cannot be verified at TRL 3. The energy case works: the 400 W east-west array stores about 1.17 kWh/day at 4 kWh/m²/day of global horizontal irradiation, which carries the 0.9 kWh/day reference load with about 10 % surplus, and the 1.15 kWh usable pack gives 1.08 days with no sun. The misses are mass (about 73.5 kg against 70 kg, R6) and cost (about \$2,006 against \$1,500, R12). Heat (R9) and pull force on grass (R7) are at risk. Every number in this note is printed by `docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`; the tag in brackets, for example [C4], is the line of that script's output that carries it.

Safety: These calculations concern a 1.28 kWh lithium battery, 120 V AC output, 100 A DC circuits, always-live PV panels and a 73 kg cart. They are first-principles estimates for a paper proof of concept and are not a substitute for component datasheets, a qualified electrical review or test. See FCL-PRC-001, Safety.

■ Scope and method

The note checks every requirement in FCL-REQ-001 v0.3 against the design in FCL-PRC-001 v0.3 and the parametric model `cad/src/model.py`. The script imports the model's `PARAMS`, so the frame, wheel, hinge and enclosure dimensions used here are the ones in the STEP files and in drawing FCL-DWG-002. Run it from the repo root with `python docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`.

■ Assumptions

Table 1. Main assumptions.

Area	Assumption	Basis
Battery	8S LiFePO ₄ , 25.6 V nominal, 50 Ah, 90 % usable; 24 V at the low end for current sizing; pack resistance 10 mΩ including BMS	Common 24 V LiFePO ₄ packs
Irradiance	"Peak sun hours" in R3 and R4 is read as daily global horizontal irradiation (GHI, kWh/m ² /day). Transposition ratios come from a clear-sky model (Meinel beam attenuation, Kasten-Young air mass, diffuse 12 % of beam, albedo 0.2, ASHRAE incidence modifier $b_0 = 0.05$) at 15, 30 and 45° N on the equinox and both solstices	Standard textbook model; ratios only, not absolute yield
PV module	200 W semi-flexible monocrystalline module bonded to a ventilated aluminium frame; Vmp 36 V, Voc 45 V, Isc 6 A; NOCT 48 °C; power coefficient -0.38 %/K; Voc -0.29 %/K, Vmp -0.35 %/K	Typical datasheet values for the class; to confirm with the chosen module
PV losses	Nameplate and early degradation 0.97, soiling 0.97, mismatch between the two wings on one MPPT 0.98, wiring 0.98, MPPT 0.96, battery charge 0.97	Engineering judgment
Load	Reference load of FCL-PRC-001, Table 3 (897 Wh/day at the outlets); DC converters 0.93; inverter 0.92 marginal efficiency plus 10 W no-load draw for 7 h; standby 12 Wh/day; filter fan 3 W for 4 h	Typical high-frequency 1 kW inverter; to confirm from datasheets
Mass	Steel 7,850 kg/m ³ , aluminium 2,700 kg/m ³ ; expanded steel deck 4.5 kg/m ² ; flat-free 16 in wheel 4.0 kg; PV wing 6.5 kg (module about 3.5 kg, frame about 3 kg)	Tube geometry from the model; others estimated
Ground	Rolling resistance 0.04 hard, 0.06 gravel, 0.10 grass; friction 0.4	Handbook ranges for 400 mm wheels
Thermal	Enclosure absorptance 0.4 (light grey), noon sun 1,000 W/m ² ; external film coefficient from laminar natural convection plus radiation (emissivity 0.9); filter fan 40 m ³ /h	Textbook correlations
Wind	Normal force coefficient 1.2 on a wing at 15°; air 1.225 kg/m ³ ; side-force coefficient 1.3 on a stowed wing wall	Flat-plate data, conservative
Noise	Inverter fan 40 dB(A) and filter fan 35 dB(A) at 1 m at 500 W	Placeholder levels, not datasheet values

■ A. Stored energy (R1)

The pack stores $25.6 \text{ V} \times 50 \text{ Ah} = 1,280 \text{ Wh}$ nominal and 1,152 Wh usable at 90 % depth of discharge [A1]. R1 asks for 1.2 kWh nominal and 1.0 kWh usable: met.

■ B. Electrical sizing (R2)

- **DC outlets.** Two 100 W USB-C PD ports and a 12 V 20 A converter give 440 W, against the 300 W target [B1].
- **Battery current.** At 1 kW AC the pack supplies 46.3 A, and 98 A in a 2 kW surge. With the DC outlets also at full output (19.7 A) the continuous total is 66.0 A, 66 % of the 100 A class T fuse and BMS rating [B2]. The surge plus full DC load is about 118 A for a few seconds, which the BMS peak rating (typically 150 to 200 A for several seconds) and the class T fuse curve must tolerate; confirm from the chosen parts.
- **Cable.** A 1.5 m loop of 16 mm² (6 AWG) copper has 1.61 mΩ, so the drop at 66 A is 0.11 V (0.4 %) with 7 W of heat [B3].
- **PV window.** Two panels in parallel keep Voc at -10 °C cell to 49.6 V, well under the 100 V MPPT limit. At 70 °C cell, Vmp falls to 30.3 V, only 0.9 V above the 29.4 V the MPPT needs to finish absorption at 28.4 V [B4].

Charging may stall near full charge on very hot days; a module with V_{mp} of 36 V or more at STC is required, and a 72-cell class module is preferred.

- **PV current.** The parallel pair gives 12 A short circuit and at most 15.0 A of MPPT output at 400 W, inside the 20 A rating. Reverse current into one panel is at most 6 A, so two panels in parallel need no per-panel fuse; the PV breaker remains as the disconnect [B5].

R2 is met by selection.

■ C. PV yield (R3)

Table 2. Transposition ratios, plane of array over global horizontal, clear sky [C0].

Site	Day	GHI (kWh/m ²)	East-west wings at 15°	South at latitude tilt	East-west over south
15° N	Equinox	7.5	0.959	1.017	0.94
15° N	June solstice	7.9	0.959	0.883	1.09
15° N	December solstice	5.6	0.948	1.162	0.82
30° N	Equinox	6.6	0.954	1.120	0.85
30° N	June solstice	8.5	0.959	0.843	1.14
30° N	December solstice	3.7	0.934	1.505	0.62
45° N	Equinox	5.1	0.946	1.328	0.71
45° N	June solstice	8.5	0.956	0.846	1.13
45° N	December solstice	1.8	0.908	2.241	0.40

The east-west wings collect on average 0.947 of the horizontal irradiation (lowest 0.908, at 45° N in December), because a 15° tilt costs little and the incidence modifier removes a few percent [C1]. Against a single panel aimed south at latitude tilt they average 0.86, a 14 % penalty, larger than the 10 % assumed at TRL 2 [C1]. The penalty is worst in winter at high latitude, where the east-west layout collects well under half of what a south panel would; FieldCell is sized for clear-season sites, not high-latitude winters.

The energy-weighted irradiance on the wings is about 636 W/m², which puts the cells at 47 °C in 25 °C air (factor 0.915) and 62 °C in 40 °C air (factor 0.858) [C2]. The overall factor from GHI to array DC output is 0.783, and 0.729 into the battery [C3].

Table 3. Energy into the battery [C4].

GHI (kWh/m ² /day)	25 °C ambient	40 °C ambient	Lowest transposition ratio
4.0	1.17 kWh	1.09 kWh	1.12 kWh
4.5	1.31 kWh	1.23 kWh	1.26 kWh
5.0	1.46 kWh	1.37 kWh	1.40 kWh

A full recharge from 10 % (1,152 Wh) takes 0.79 day at 5 kWh/m²/day and 0.99 day at 4 [C5]. Peak charge power at noon is about 260 to 290 W [C6]. R3 asks for 1.1 kWh/day at 4 and a full recharge in one day at 5: met at 25 °C, with the 4 kWh/m²/day figure falling to 1.09 kWh in 40 °C air.

■ D. Load and autonomy (R4)

Table 4. Reference load drawn from the battery [D1, D2].

Path	At outlet	From battery
DC (lighting, charging), 0.93 converters	480 Wh	516 Wh
AC (laptop, router, tool), 0.92 plus 10 W idle for 7 h	417 Wh	523 Wh (70 Wh of it idle)
Standby (BMS, monitor, MPPT at night, converter idle)		12 Wh
Electronics box filter fan, 3 W for 4 h		12 Wh
Total	897 Wh	1,063 Wh (overall 0.844)

With 1,152 Wh usable, the pack carries the load for 1.08 days with no sun [D3]. The energy balance is +104 Wh/day (+10 %) at 4 kWh/m²/day, +250 Wh (+24 %) at 4.5 and +396 Wh (+37 %) at 5 [D4]. The system breaks even at 3.64 kWh/m²/day in 25 °C air and 3.88 in 40 °C air [D5]. Inverter idle draw is the most sensitive assumption: every extra 5 W of no-load draw costs 35 Wh/day, 3.3 % of the load [D6]. R4 is met, with thin margins.

■ E. Mass, center of gravity and handle force (R6)

The frame tubes total 3.96 m of 40 × 40 × 1.5 mm steel at 1.81 kg/m (7.2 kg). With the deck (2.6 kg), axle (1.8 kg) and brackets (1.2 kg) the welded steel frame is 12.8 kg; a bolted aluminium frame would be about 6.7 kg [E1].

Table 5. Mass budget, wings stowed, parked level. *X* from the deck center toward the handle; the axle is at *X* = 30 mm [E2, E3].

Item	Mass (kg)	X (mm)	Z (mm)
Frame, deck and axle	12.8	0	430
Wheels, flat-free (2 × 4.0 kg)	8.0	30	203
Handle	2.7	950	700
Stand legs (4)	1.8	0	230
Battery enclosure	3.0	0	610
LiFePO4 pack	12.0	0	576
Electronics enclosure and filter fan	3.3	420	610
Inverter (high-frequency)	4.0	420	521
MPPT, fusing, monitor, outlets	4.0	420	580
Accessory bin and cables	4.0	-420	560
PV wings, stowed (2 × 6.5 kg)	13.0	0	820
Hinges, latches, outriggers, stakes	3.0	0	780
Wiring and hardware	2.0	200	600
Total	73.5	85	557

The cart weighs about 73.5 kg, 3.5 kg over the 70 kg limit of R6 [E3]. The TRL 2 budget of 68.5 kg underestimated the steel frame (11.0 kg budgeted), the flat-free wheels (6.0 kg for two) and the hinges and outriggers (2.0 kg). The center of gravity is 55 mm toward the handle from the axle, so the handle carries 32 N when level and 14 to 50 N over a 5° pitch either way, inside the 10 to 150 N band [E4]. The heaviest removable module is the 12.0 kg pack, against a 25 kg limit [E6].

The decided steel frame and flat-free tyres are the cause of the miss. An aluminium frame would bring the cart to 67.4 kg; pneumatic tyres alone to 71.1 kg; both to 65.0 kg [E5]. R6 is **not met**. Options are in docs/REVIEW.md , proposed and awaiting Amish.

■ F. Rough ground and structure (R7)

Table 6. Pull force on a 10 % grade [F1].

Surface	Rolling resistance	Pull force
Hard or packed	0.04	100 N
Gravel	0.06	115 N
Grass	0.10	144 N

- **Step.** Pulled handle first onto a 150 mm step, the 203 mm wheel meets the edge 196 mm ahead of the axle. Taking moments about the edge, the user needs about 136 N of horizontal pull at the grip; a straight push at the axle would need about 2,670 N, so the step is climbed by pulling at the handle, not by pushing [F2].

- **Clearance and tipping.** Ground clearance under the axle is 193 mm and the lateral static tip angle is 32.9° [F3].
- **Wing to tyre.** When deployed, the wing underside clears the tyre top by only 8 mm at the tyre's outer edge [F4]. Any tyre growth, a bent hinge or mud on the tyre closes the gap. A 20 mm hinge spacer is proposed (see docs/REVIEW.md).
- **Strength.** At a 2 g bump, a side rail with 30 kg cantilevered 0.4 m sees 118 N·m and 41 MPa, a factor of 5.7 on S235 yield; the 20 mm axle sees 50 N·m and 64 MPa, a factor of about 5.4 on bright mild steel [F5]. Welds, fatigue and the handle joint are not assessed at TRL 3.

R7 is **at risk**: every target is met on paper, but the pull force on grass is within 4 % of the 150 N limit, and it grows with any further mass.

■ G. Thermal (R8, R9)

The electronics enclosure has 0.62 m² of walls and top. Its heat load is 68 W at 500 W AC and 140 W at 1 kW AC, and noon sun can add up to 86 W on a light grey box [G1].

Table 7. Electronics enclosure air temperature at 45 °C ambient [G2].

Case	Sealed box	With a 40 m ³ /h filter fan
500 W AC	56 °C (+10.7 K)	49 °C (+3.5 K)
1 kW AC	65 °C (+20.2 K)	52 °C (+7.3 K)
1 kW AC with half the solar gain	70 °C (+25.5 K)	54 °C (+9.5 K)

A sealed box is not workable at 1 kW in hot weather. An IP54 filter fan with a matching exhaust filter keeps the box within about 10 K of ambient; a 10 K rise at 1 kW in sun needs about 55 m³/h [G3], so the fan should be sized at 40 to 60 m³/h. This resolves the TRL 2 question of ventilation against IP54 (R8), since IP54 filter fans are standard parts; it adds a fan to the noise budget (R11) and about 12 Wh/day to the load. At 45 °C ambient, the box interior still reaches about 54 °C, above the 40 °C at which most 1 kW inverters begin to derate, so full 1 kW output at 45 °C is not assured.

The battery case in noon sun absorbs about 60 W and settles about 10 K above ambient with a time constant of about 0.8 h [G4]. The pack therefore reaches about 55 °C at 45 °C ambient and 45 °C at 35 °C [G5], at or above the usual 45 °C charge limit of LiFePO₄ cells, so the BMS will block charging in the hottest hours. Pack self-heating is small: 21 W at 1 kW and under 1 Wh/day at the reference load [G4]. At –10 °C the BMS blocks charging below 0 °C cell temperature as required, so on cold days little PV energy is stored until the pack warms.

R8 is **not verifiable at TRL 3** (it needs a spray and dust test). R9 is **at risk**: the low-temperature charge block is met by selection, but hot-weather output and charging need a sun shade over both enclosures and inverter derating data.

■ H. Wind (R10)

- **Unstaked wing.** A 0.98 m² wing of 6.5 kg lifts about its hinge at about 9.2 m/s [H1].
- **Staked at 15 m/s.** The dynamic pressure is 138 Pa and the normal force 162 N per wing. Each staked outrigger foot must resist 27 N of pull-out, or 49 N with a 1.5 load factor [H2], well within a 300 mm steel stake in firm soil (commonly a few hundred newtons).

- **Whole cart at 15 m/s.** Worst-case uplift on both wings is 313 N against a weight of 721 N. The lateral load of 125 N is below the 163 N friction of an unstaked cart; staked, it is about 31 N per foot [H3].
- **Stowed.** Side wind on one wing wall overturns the stowed cart at about 20 m/s [H4].

R10 is met with the four feet staked or ballasted, as the requirement states. Unstaked, the wings must be stowed above about 9 m/s.

■ I. Deployment and noise (R5, R11)

Task analysis gives 6.0 min to deploy and 5.0 min to stow, against 10 min each [I1]. R5 is met by analysis; a timed trial is TRL 4 work. With the assumed source levels, the inverter fan and filter fan together give about 41.2 dB(A) at 1 m at 500 W [I2], but neither level comes from a datasheet, so R11 is **not verifiable at TRL 3**.

■ J. Cost (R12)

The 17-line BOM totals \$2,006, \$506 (34 %) over the \$1,500 budget [J1]. The largest lines are the two PV wings (\$460), the pack (\$300) and the inverter (\$220) [J2]. The TRL 2 figure of \$1,462 priced rigid-frame 200 W panels at \$135 each; a rigid glass panel of that rating weighs about 11 to 12 kg, which would add about 10 kg to a cart already over its mass limit, so the semi-flexible module on a light frame is kept and costs more. Fusing, monitoring and outlets were also underpriced. R12 is **not met** on cost; its electrical safety provisions are met by design.

■ K. Envelope

Deployed, the cart covers 1,984 × 2,012 mm including the handle; stowed with the handle removed it is 1,400 × 784 × 1,170 mm [K1], which fits a pickup bed between the wheel wells and most vans.

■ Results

Table 8. Requirement status. Status is one of met, not met, at risk, or not verifiable at TRL 3.

ID	Quantity	Value (FCL-CAL-001)	Target (FCL-REQ-001)	Status
R1	Stored energy	1.28 kWh nominal, 1.15 kWh usable [A1]	1.2 kWh nominal, 1.0 kWh usable	Met
R2	AC and DC output	1 kW AC, 2 kW surge by selection; 440 W DC; 66 A continuous on a 100 A fuse [B1, B2]	1 kW AC, 2 kW surge; 300 W DC	Met
R3	PV recharge	1.17 kWh/day at 4 kWh/m ² /day (1.09 at 40 °C); full recharge 0.79 day at 5 [C4, C5]	1.1 kWh/day at 4; full recharge in 1 day at 5	Met
R4	Autonomy	1.08 days with no sun; +10 % at 4 kWh/m ² /day [D3, D4]	1 day; energy-neutral at 4	Met
R5	Deploy and stow	6.0 min deploy, 5.0 min stow by task analysis [I1]	10 min each	Met
R6	Mass and handle force	73.5 kg; 14 to 50 N; pack 12.0 kg [E3, E4, E6]	70 kg; 10 to 150 N; module 25 kg	Not met (mass)
R7	Rough ground	406 mm wheels; 193 mm clearance; step at 136 N pull; 144 N on grass; tip 32.9° [F1 to F3]	406 mm; 150 mm; 150 mm step; 150 N; 25°	At risk
R8	Rain and dust	IP54 box with IP54 filter fan and filter; IP65 battery case; glands (by selection)	IP54 operating; IP65; glands	Not verifiable at TRL 3
R9	Temperature	Box 54 °C at 45 °C ambient with fan; pack in sun about 55 °C; charge blocked below 0 °C by BMS [G2, G5]	–10 to 45 °C; charge block below 0 °C; derating known	At risk
R10	Wind	Staked: 27 N pull-out per foot at 15 m/s (49 N factored); unstaked lift at 9.2 m/s [H1, H2]	Stable to 15 m/s staked or ballasted	Met
R11	Noise	About 41 dB(A) at 1 m from assumed source levels [I2]	45 dB(A) at 1 m at 500 W	Not verifiable at TRL 3
R12	Safety and cost	Fusing, GFCI, isolator, no inlet by design; parts \$2,006 [J1]	Safety provisions; \$1,500	Not met (cost)

Summary: 6 met (R1, R2, R3, R4, R5, R10), 2 not met (R6, R12), 2 at risk (R7, R9), 2 not verifiable at TRL 3 (R8, R11).

■ Checks against earlier figures

The TRL 2 figures in FCL-PRC-001 v0.2 and FCL-REQ-001 v0.2 were checked against this note and corrected in v0.3 of both documents: mass 68.5 to 73.5 kg; CG offset 63 to 55 mm; handle force 17 to 52 N to 14 to 50 N; lateral tip 32 to 32.9°; pull on grass 135 to 144 N; east-west penalty 10 to 14 %; stored energy at 4 h 1.12 to 1.17 kWh/day, now against GHI; load from the battery 1,025 to 1,063 Wh/day; autonomy 1.1 to 1.08 days; surplus at 4 h 9 to 10 %; parts \$1,462 to \$2,006. The unstaked lift-off speed (about 9 m/s) and deploy time (about 6 min) are confirmed.